```
gigabytesToMegabytes 7
# 7168
```

What sorts of things do you define in a language? That depends on the problem you're solving.

Keeping track of attendees

Time to get back to counting the list of party attendees. Imagine a list of confirmed attendees is emailed to you with the name of each confirmed attendee separated from the next by a comma. The list is too long to print here, but the first part of the list looks like this:

```
'Batman,Joker,Wolverine,Sabertooth,The Green Lantern,Sinestro'
```

Sounds like a fun party. Anyway, you don't want to manually count the new list every time it arrives in your inbox. How do you write a program to count the list for you?

CoffeeScript doesn't have a built-in operator or method to count the number of comma-separated words in a string, but it's possible to count them by using the `split` method for strings that you saw in chapter 2. Split the string into an array of strings, and then use the array's `length` property. Try it on the REPL:

```
text = 'Monday,Tuesday,Wednesday,Thursday,Friday,Saturday,Sunday'
daysInWeek = text.split(/,/)
daysInWeek.length
# 7

text = 'Spring,Summer,Autumn,Winter'
seasons = text.split(/,/)
seasons.length
# 4
```

Split the string on the comma character to get an array of words.

Use the length property of the array.

If you're a masochist, then you'll happily do that over and over again, and over and over again, every time you have another string. Otherwise, you can write a program to count the words and use that program each time you want to count. The following listing contains a CoffeeScript program that runs on Node.js and counts the number of words in a comma-separated